

WORKING WITH AI

Stop briefing the AI. Give it somewhere to live.

The difference between chatting to an AI and running one. Most people are doing the first and wondering why it never gets easier. This is what the second one looks like, and what it takes to build.

You've become the operating system

If you're using AI through a chat window, you're doing four jobs it can't do for itself. You supply the context. You supply the standards. You judge the output. Then you carry the result somewhere else by hand.

Worth saying up front: the more hours you've put in, the more you'll feel this, not less. Someone who's barely used AI doesn't notice, because they're still impressed that it writes at all. It's the heavy users who hit the ceiling, because they've already squeezed everything a chat window can give and the friction that's left isn't a skill problem. It's structural. You can't prompt your way out of it.

None of that is a failure of the model. It's a failure of where the model sits. A chat window has no idea what your business is, what you charge, how you talk, who you spoke to on Tuesday, or what you decided three weeks ago. So you tell it. Every time. And the moment you close the tab, everything you taught it is gone.

Projects help. They give the AI a fixed pile of documents to read before it answers, which is a real improvement over starting cold. But look at what a project still can't do:

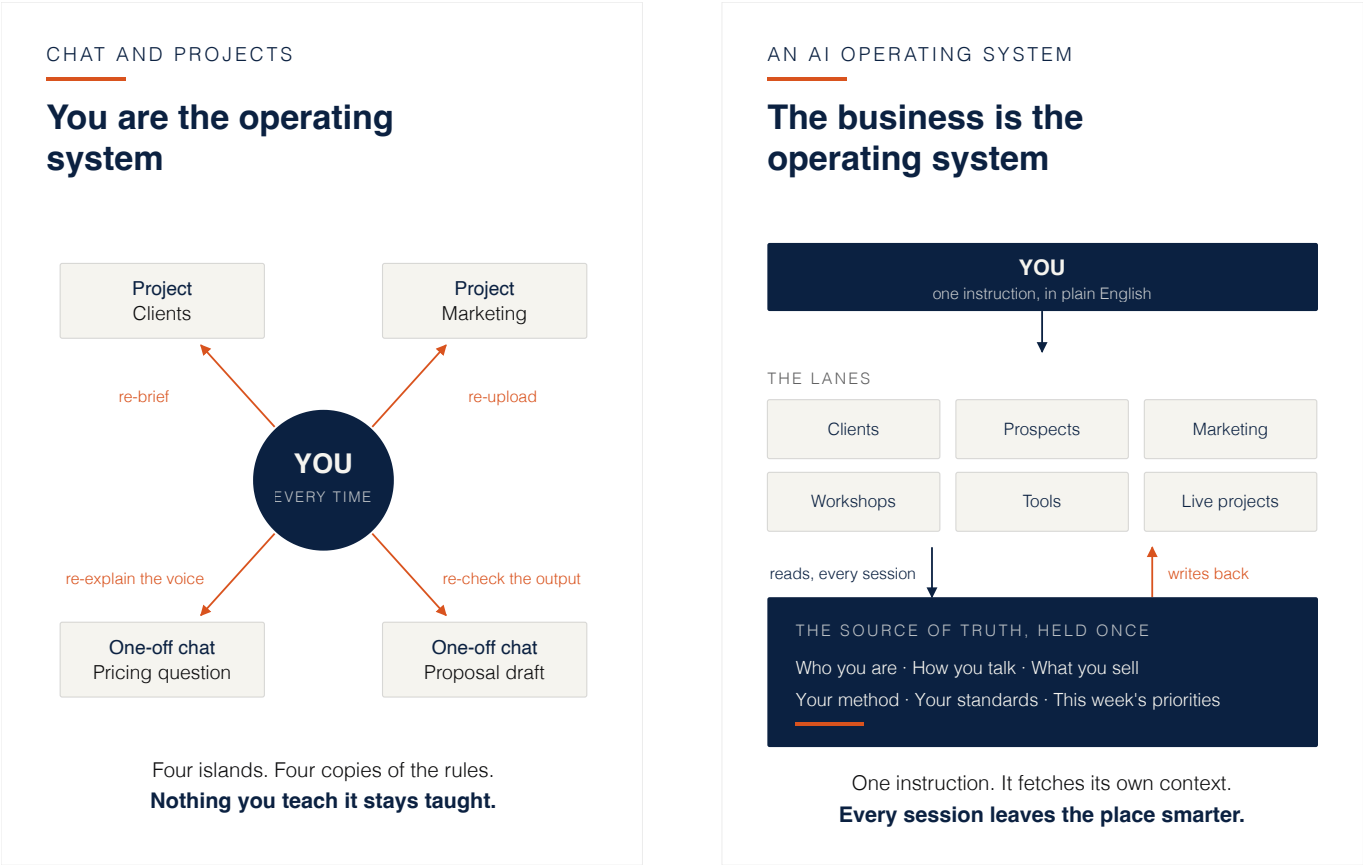
- **It can only read. It can't file.** The AI can't update a client record, log a decision, or write down what just happened. So the pile only stays current if you maintain it by hand, and nobody does.
- **Every project is its own island.** Your tone rules live in five projects, in five slightly different versions, drifting apart. There's no single source you fix once.
- **The output stops at the text.** It hands you words. You still open the other app, paste it in, format it, send it. The AI does the thinking and you do the doing.
- **Nothing compounds.** Session ten is no smarter about your business than session one. You're the only thing carrying continuity, and you're carrying it in your head.



The diagnosis: the constraint isn't the model's intelligence. It's that the AI has no memory of your business, no standards to check itself against, and no hands. You're supplying all three, every session, for free.

Two ways to work

On the left is how most people work with AI. On the right is what changes when the business itself becomes the thing the AI reads from and writes to.



Left: you carry the context between islands. Right: the context sits under everything, and the work is filed back into it.

"Write a follow-up to the bloke I spoke to on Tuesday"

Same sentence, typed into both. Watch where the work lands.

STEP	IN A CHAT OR PROJECT	IN AN OPERATING SYSTEM
Who is he	You explain. Name, business, size, what he does, where he's stuck.	It opens his file and reads it.
What was said	You paste your notes, if you took any.	Tuesday's conversation is already on the record, dated.
What to offer	You re-explain your offers and prices, and hope you got them right.	It reads the current offers and prices from one file, the same one you fixed last time.
How it sounds	You paste tone notes, then rewrite the draft anyway.	Your voice rules load automatically, and a second pass checks the draft against them before you see it.
Sending it	You copy it out, reformat it, send it.	It drafts, you approve, it goes. Nothing leaves without your yes.
Afterwards	The thread scrolls away. Nothing about Tuesday is recorded anywhere.	The exchange is logged to his file. Next time, that's context it already has.

Look at the last row. That's the one that compounds. In a chat, every conversation ends at zero. In an OS, every conversation leaves the place slightly better briefed than it found it. Do that for a year and the gap isn't small.

Five shifts, in order of how much time they give back

SHIFT ONE

Context loads itself

There's one file at the top of the folder describing the business: what it is, who it serves, what it charges, how it talks, what matters right now. It's read at the start of every session, without being asked. You stop introducing yourself to your own AI.

SHIFT TWO

Your standards become files, not reminders

The tone rules, the banned words, the pricing facts, the things you never say: those live in one place and get checked automatically. Fix a rule once and every piece of work from that moment on obeys it. Compare that with correcting the same thing in four different projects and hoping you got them all.

SHIFT THREE

The AI has hands

This is the big one and it's easy to miss. It doesn't only answer, it does. It reads your CRM, checks what money came in, drafts the document, builds the PDF, updates the record, publishes the page. In a chat, the AI does the thinking and hands you homework. Here it does the work and hands you the result to approve.

SHIFT FOUR

Repetition turns into one command

When you've explained the same process three times, you stop explaining it and write it down as a command. Processing the week's coaching calls into client records, checking who's gone quiet, pulling the month's cash across every payment system: each of those used to be an hour of prompting. Now they're a word. Same steps, same standard, every time, whether you're sharp that morning or not.

SHIFT FIVE

It's yours, and it's one place

It's a folder on your machine, backed up and synced to your phone and your other computer. Not a chat history you'll never find again, not locked inside one company's app. If you switched AI tools tomorrow, the business record walks with you.

Six lanes, one foundation

The screenshot you've been sent shows sessions grouped into lanes. That grouping isn't decoration. Each lane is a drawer in one filing cabinet, and every drawer reads from the same foundation underneath.

- **Clients.** A folder per member: who they are, what was diagnosed, every dated interaction, what they've committed to. The relationship record, not a memory.
- **Prospects.** Same structure, before they've joined. When one enrolls, the folder moves across intact. Nothing gets retyped.
- **Marketing pillars.** The themes the content comes from, the evidence behind each one, and the drafts in flight. Content stops being invented from nothing every week.
- **Workshops and events.** The delivery playbook, the handouts, the attendee list, what happened last time. Running the next one is a repeat, not a rebuild.
- **Tools.** The things being built. Specs, notes, what's live, what broke.
- **Live projects.** Whatever's actually in flight this month, pinned to the top so it's the first thing seen.

Underneath all six sits the foundation: identity, voice, offers and prices, method, values, standards, this week's priorities. Every lane reads it. You maintain it once.



The philosophy, in one line: stop treating AI as a clever assistant you brief, and start treating it as staff who work in your building. Staff need the manual, the filing cabinet, and permission to act. Give it those three and the relationship changes.

This is the dumbest it will ever be

A chat window on day four hundred is identical to a chat window on day one. Same blank box, same amnesia, same four jobs waiting for you. An OS runs the other way. Today is the least it will ever know about how you operate.

That isn't a claim about the models improving, though they will. It's about the thing you're building underneath them. Three mechanics do the work, and none of them are magic: they're routines, and closing a session properly is what runs them.

- **It learns from correction, once.** When you correct something, the correction gets written into the file that loads at the start of every session. You're not repeating yourself next week, or next year. Every correction is permanent, and they stack.
- **It cleans itself.** Stale work gets archived instead of rotting among the live files, duplicates get merged, and the snapshot of where the business is at gets rebuilt from source rather than drifting. A pile that only grows is just a mess. The tidying is what keeps it a system.
- **It audits itself.** Drafts get checked against your standards before you ever see them, so you're editing less each month. Decisions get written down with a date to revisit them, so they resurface on their own rather than quietly going out of date.

What you notice after a few months isn't that it knows more facts. It's that it's more nuanced about how you actually operate: which client needs the direct version, which offer to hold back, what you'd never put in writing. That isn't the model getting cleverer. That's your business being written down properly for the first time.

What this costs, and when chat is still right

Three things worth knowing before starting, because the pitch usually skips them.

- **It's a habit, not a build.** There's no project to finish. The cost is a few minutes at the end of a session writing down what happened. Skip that and the whole thing degrades into an expensive folder of stale notes.
- **It's a terminal, and that puts people off.** You type in plain English, so it isn't coding. But it doesn't look like a chat app, and the first hour feels unfamiliar. That's the actual barrier, and it lasts about a day.
- **It can act, so the guardrails matter.** Something that can send, publish and spend needs clear rules about what it does on its own and what it must ask about first. Write those rules early rather than after something goes out that shouldn't have.

Chat is still the right tool for

Quick one-off questions. Thinking out loud. Anything you don't need to keep. Nobody should build a filing system to ask what a term means. The line is simple: if the answer matters again next month, it belongs in the OS. If it doesn't, use the chat window.

Do this in an afternoon

Don't build the cathedral. Build one drawer and see if it holds.

- **Make one folder.** Not six. One, for the whole business, on your machine.
- **Write the brief.** A single page: what the business is, who it serves, what you sell and for how much, how you talk, what you're focused on this quarter. Speak it out loud and let the AI write it up if that's faster, then correct it. This is the file everything else stands on.
- **Move one lane in.** Not the easiest one. The one that's actually stuck. For a lot of people that's clients or prospects, where the history is scattered across four apps and nothing's written down. For others it sits further upstream, which is the next bit.
- **Work in it for a fortnight.** Real work, not a test. Close each session by writing down what happened, what changed, what's still open. Two minutes.
- **Then write your first command.** Whatever you've now explained three times, capture it as a repeatable step. That's the moment the compounding starts.

FURTHER UPSTREAM

If the lane that's stuck is the offer itself

Sometimes the blockage isn't clients or prospects. It's the thing you're actually selling, which exists in full in your head, has never been written down in one place, and so comes out slightly differently every time you describe it. New name, new framing, new emphasis. Every version is an improvement on the last and none of them is finished.

That's the lane to start with, and it's the one an OS is unreasonably good at, for a reason that isn't obvious. An offer isn't a document you write once. It's a position that has to hold its shape across a landing page, a programme outline, an email, a conversation and a book. Hold it in one file at the foundation and everything downstream reads from it. Change your mind and you change it once, rather than hunting it across five places and finding three of them still say the old thing.

Worth being plain about what this does and doesn't do. It doesn't write the position for you, and it shouldn't. The words should stay yours. What it does is stop the position drifting while you're busy refining it, which is the failure mode for people whose thinking is good enough that refining feels like progress.

Then the marketing gets built on top of it rather than alongside it, which is the part most people do in the wrong order. There's a process I run with members for exactly this. It's mostly a sequence of questions asked in a particular order. Happy to point you at it.

What to expect: week one feels slower, because you're writing things down that used to live in your head. Week three is where it flips, when the AI starts answering with things you'd forgotten you told it. Give it three weeks before you judge it.

ONE QUESTION

How much of your business only exists in your head?

Everything you re-explain to an AI is something you've never written down. That's not an AI problem, it's a business problem, and it's the same reason the business can't run without you in the room. Building the OS forces you to write it down. Most people find that's worth more than the AI.

ONE MORE THING, AND THEN I'LL SHUT UP

If you'd rather not build it from scratch

You can build all of this yourself. With your mileage you'd get there, and everything you need to start is in section 08. The only thing actually worth paying for is the wrong turns you get to skip, which is about a day's work with your own business as the material.

Ordinarily that's \$5,500 plus GST. I'd rather not send you an invoice, because I think there are other areas we could explore together. You've got a room full of exactly the people I'm being told I should be talking to, and I've got sixteen years of the commercial half you said you haven't built yet. There's a swap in that somewhere. Let's keep exploring how this might benefit both of us.